



European Municipal Associations Summit

Brussels • October 2026

Municipal Associations Shaping a Common Agenda



Hosted by the Union of Municipalities of Türkiye (TBB)



Climate Finance



Multi-level
Governance



Representation



Capacity Building



European Municipal Associations Summit

DRAFT PROGRAMME

FRAMING

About the Summit

Municipal Associations Shaping a Common Agenda

The summit brings together national and European-level municipal associations in Brussels to articulate the distinctive added value of associations. This half-day meeting will address the structural barriers to municipalities' access to climate finance and to their participation in decision-making; the discussions will feed directly into the Joint Position Paper of Municipal Associations currently being prepared by TBB.

THE CORE QUESTION

“Which functions that individual municipalities struggle to perform alone can municipal associations deliver jointly and effectively?”

01**Purpose**

To demonstrate, through concrete examples, the roles of municipal associations in representation, capacity building and facilitating access to finance.

02**Method**

A moderated focused discussion, followed by two long thematic sessions held consecutively with the same group of participants.

03**Outcome**

To carry participants' views and their feedback on the draft position paper into the COP31 and Turkiye Working Group process.

1

Half Day

2

Consecutive Thematic Sessions

1

Joint Position Paper

Context — COP31 and the Turkiye Working Group

The shared problems, proposed solutions and priority messages recorded at the summit will be carried into the COP31 process and the Turkiye Working Group meeting.

— FLOW OF THE DAY

The Programme at a Glance

	14:00 – 14:20	Registration & Welcome	REGISTRATION	20'
	14:20 – 14:30	Opening – The Common Agenda of Municipal Associations	PLENARY	10'
	14:30 – 15:00	Focused Discussion – The Distinctive Added Value of Municipal Associations	DISCUSSION	30'
	15:00 – 15:10	Coffee Break	BREAK	10'
	15:10 – 16:10	Thematic Session I – The Role of Municipal Associations in Accessing Climate Finance	SESSION I	60'
	16:10 – 17:10	Thematic Session II – Bringing the Local Voice into Decision-Making	SESSION II	60'
	17:10 – 17:40	Feedback on the Position Paper and the COP31 Messages	FEEDBACK	30'
	17:40 – 17:50	Closing, Drafting Process and Next Steps	CLOSING	10'
	17:50 – 18:30	Networking & Cocktail Reception	NETWORKING	40'

Plenary & Closing
 Discussion & Feedback
 Thematic Session
 Break & Registration
 Networking

PROGRAMME · 14:00 – 15:10

Opening and Focused Discussion

14:00 – 14:20

20'

REGISTRATION

Registration & Welcome

Welcome and registration of participants.

14:20 – 14:30

10'

PLENARY

Opening – The Common Agenda of Municipal Associations

Short opening remarks by TBB and a European-level municipal association. The summit's core question, expected outcomes and working method are presented.

14:30 – 15:00

30'

DISCUSSION

Focused Discussion – The Distinctive Added Value of Municipal Associations

The associations' functions — identifying shared needs, representing local government, building capacity, facilitating access to finance and carrying local demands to different levels — are examined through concrete examples.

GUIDING QUESTION

“Which functions that individual municipalities struggle to perform alone can municipal associations deliver jointly and effectively?”

15:00 – 15:10 Coffee Break → 15:10 – 17:10 Two Thematic Sessions**NEXT PAGE**

CONSECUTIVE SESSIONS • 15:10 – 17:10

Two Thematic Sessions

**15:10 –
17:10**

**120' •
CONSECUTIVE**

All participants remain in the same room; the two topics are addressed one after the other.

THEMATIC SESSION I • 15:10 – 16:10 • 60'

The Role of Municipal Associations in Accessing Climate Finance

How municipal associations can aggregate financing and technical assistance needs, strengthen municipalities' project preparation capacity, and broker relations with financial institutions.

Aggregating needs

Project preparation capacity

Relations with financiers

GUIDING QUESTION

“How can municipal associations facilitate cities' access to suitable finance and technical support for green investments?”

THEMATIC SESSION II • 16:10 – 17:10 • 60'

Bringing the Local Voice into Decision-Making

How municipal associations can strengthen the channels of consultation, representation, data sharing and coordination between the local, regional, national and European levels.

Consultation & representation

Data sharing

Cross-level coordination

GUIDING QUESTION

“How can municipal associations carry cities' shared needs and demands into national and international decision-making processes more effectively?”



The findings of both sessions feed directly into the feedback on the position paper and the COP31 messages, starting at 17:10.

PROGRAMME • 17:10 – 18:30

Feedback and Closing

17:10 – 17:40

30'

FEEDBACK**Feedback on the Position Paper and the COP31 Messages**

The main orientation of the Joint Position Paper being prepared by TBB and the messages envisaged for COP31 are presented. Participants raise gaps, priorities and suggestions for strengthening the text.

17:40 – 17:50

10'

CLOSING**Closing, Drafting Process and Next Steps**

TBB explains how it will synthesise the contributions, how the draft will be shared with participants, and the follow-up process.

17:50 – 18:30

40'

NETWORKING**Networking & Cocktail Reception**

An opportunity for participating institutions to connect, explore possible collaborations and plan follow-up meetings.

SUMMIT OUTCOME

Joint Position Paper of Municipal Associations

The views expressed at the summit and the feedback on the position paper are synthesised by TBB; the priority messages are carried into the COP31 process and the Türkiye Working Group meeting.



AFTER THE SUMMIT

Next Steps

1

Synthesis of Summit Findings

Thematic session notes and feedback on the position paper are compiled by TBB.

2

Draft Joint Position Paper

The paper is updated and shared with participating municipal associations for their views.

3

COP31 & Turkiye Working Group

The priority messages set out in the paper are carried into the relevant international and regional processes.

PRACTICAL INFORMATION

At a Glance

Date	13 October 2026
Venue	CEMR Meeting Room, Brussels
Duration	14:00 – 18:30 (networking included)
Language	Turkish and English
Participation	National and European-level municipal associations
Format	Plenary + 2 consecutive thematic sessions

NOTES

PLANNING NOTE

The CEMR meeting room has been reserved for 13 October 2026.



Union of Municipalities of Turkiye

Draft Programme



EUROPEAN UNION